

# Urban Web – Program Charter

## Executive Summary

Urban Web is a joint program by Networks for Humanity (NFH) and World Resources Institute (WRI) to deploy open mobility networks in cities across multiple geographies simultaneously. It brings together NFH's Beckn Fabric — a live, peer-to-peer global infrastructure for value exchange — and WRI's city relationships, policy expertise, and on-the-ground research across Latin America, Europe, and Asia. The program's goal is concrete and measurable: two cities, running fully transactional open mobility networks, at scale, within twelve months.

## What We Are Building

Cities do not need another platform. They need a way to compose new mobility, energy, and finance flows across what they already have — quickly, reliably, and at low marginal cost. Urban Web offers exactly this. It is built on the Beckn Fabric, which provides a globally deployed, decentralised infrastructure for discovery, trust, contracting, and value exchange across any mobility service — bus, metro, ride-hail, parking, EV charging, bike-share — without bilateral integrations or vendor dependency. On top of this, NFH offers differentiated on-fabric services like **Pincer**, a cryptographic guarantee mechanism that delivers zero-cancellation and fulfilment reliability at the network level, and **Vouch**, a purpose-specific voucher system enabling employers, governments, and programmes to fund specific mobility behaviours with programmable, non-fungible value.

What this changes, concretely, depends on who you are:

- **For residents and workers:** one consistent experience to plan, discover, book, and pay across buses, metro, taxis, e-bikes, parking, and EV charging — with reliability as a first-class feature built at the network level, not platform by platform. The interface through which residents access all of this is changing. The next generation of urban residents will not navigate mobility through apps, they will use agents. Natural language interfaces and agentic AI are already reshaping how people discover, decide, and transact. Urban Web is built on open, machine-readable infrastructure on which intelligent agents can naturally operate across providers, modes, and cities without being trapped inside any single platform's walls.



- **For operators and ecosystem:** open, plug-and-play participation where any operator — public or private, large or small — publishes services via open APIs instead of bespoke integrations. Access to working capital and asset finance by exposing verifiable, machine-readable transaction records as proof of business. Shared tools for driver credentialing, fleet asset management, and B2B procurement across operators.
- **For cities and climate goals:** demand-side tools that complement traditional supply-side investments — pricing, parking, vouchers, and green credits that can be tuned over time. Lower congestion and emissions through better utilisation of existing assets and incentives for greener choices. And crucially: a replicable blueprint so that what works in one city can be adapted quickly in another.

The goal Urban Web is working toward is one where any city in the world can join a global open mobility network, bring its operators and assets onto shared infrastructure, and immediately unlock multimodal integration, operator financing, driver credentialing, and demand-side incentives — without building from scratch or becoming dependent on a vendor.

## The Path to Scale

|                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
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| <b>Phase 1: Launch &amp; City Outreach (4 weeks)</b>        | <i>Create the public face of the program and seed the first city conversations</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Launch dedicated website presenting Urban Web as a city-friendly list of illustrative use cases</li> <li>• Deploy agentic, clickable mock demos showing AI-native use of the network</li> <li>• Send structured outreach note to 10–15 seeded city contacts</li> <li>• Develop investor pitch targeting city co-contribution and foundation matching</li> </ul> |
| <b>Phase 2: City Identification &amp; Scoping (4 weeks)</b> | Identify cities and understand what their particular needs are                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Conduct targeted workshops with interested cities</li> <li>• Draft a 2–3 page city brief per city: care/concern, Urban Web fit, initial bundle</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

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|                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Confirm minimum two cities across different geographies</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Phase 3: Proposals &amp; Agreements (4 weeks)</b> | Confirming and finalising commitments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Submit detailed implementation proposal per city</li> <li>Cities contribute via choice of funding (innovation fund, development grants, etc.); NFH and WRI match through foundation funding</li> <li>Sign MOUs per city</li> <li>Formally launch Global Open Network Alliance with WRI, NFH, Google, Mastercard, World Bank</li> </ul> |
| <b>Phase 4: Cycle 1 - Deployment (12 weeks)</b>      | 90-day cycle to launch the network in the city                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Three 30-day engineering sprints</li> <li>Onboard operators onto the Fabric</li> <li>Activate chosen use cases per city</li> <li>Target: 200 transactions per day in each city</li> <li>Produce first multi-city, multi-region reference cases outside India</li> </ul>                                                                |
| <b>Phase 5: Cycle 2 - Scale (16 weeks)</b>           | Building on the foundation from Cycle 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Scale to 200,000 transactions per day across both cities</li> <li>Activate secondary use cases: operator financing, driver credentials, Vouch programmes</li> <li>Package evidence base for global stakeholder convenings</li> <li>Anchor to Annual World Bank Meeting for global announcement</li> </ul>                              |



## Roles & Responsibilities (WIP)

Urban Web is a program co-led by NFH and WRI, along with city partners who are active participants in the program. Roles of all parties are complementary and designed to reach a common goal.

| Networks for Humanity                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | World Resources Institute                                                                                                                                                                                                               | City Partners                                                                                                                                       |
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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Beckn Fabric infrastructure and technical onboarding</li> <li>• On-fabric service offerings</li> <li>• Reference implementations and open toolkits</li> <li>• Technical support through deployment cycles</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• City partnerships and stakeholder engagement</li> <li>• Policy framing and regulatory navigation</li> <li>• Research, evidence, and impact measurement</li> <li>• Program narrative</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Local operator and ecosystem onboarding</li> <li>• Co-governance of network rules and standards</li> </ul> |